Each night you had to write your thoughts and feelings in your notebook. You would go over it with your counsellor the next day. We'd finish the early session with a reading of the 'Serenity Prayer'. It took me a while, but I actually learnt the prayer off by heart …

God grant me the serenity
To accept the things I cannot change;
The courage to change the things I can;
And the wisdom to know the difference.
Living one day at a time;
Enjoying one moment at a time;
Accepting hardships as the pathway to peace;
Taking, as He did, this sinful world
As it is, not as I would have it;
Trusting that He will make all things right
If I surrender to His Will;
That I may be reasonably happy in this life
And supremely happy with Him
Forever in the next.
Amen.

Then it was breakfast at 7.30 a.m. The food at the clinic wasn't too bad. I ate a lot of toast, though, but actually got pretty thin, which happens if I don't go to gym – I lose a lot of muscle mass. There were some treadmills in a small gym at the clinic, but there weren't too many free weights. Ja, and a tennis court too. I played a little tennis as well.

Anyway, after breakfast, the day's sessions would start at 8.45. We worked from manuals and had to do a lot of written work, too. The sessions comprised various aspects of your addiction – its consequences, the people in your life whom it has affected, the causes behind your behaviour …

The classes were also the only time we had any contact with the female 'guests'. And even then we had to sit in separate rows of chairs. After the sessions, they would file out and go to their own section of the clinic. Naturally I found this highly amusing. Not to mention challenging. I missed not chatting to a girl way more than I missed alcohol.

I mean, you weren't even allowed to wink at the women or you were given a warning. And after three warnings they packed your bags and